

Virtual reality is a simulation (the virtual part) of some part of real world (the reality part). In most cases known, the simulation is done in either of two ways:

- 1 The subject (person) is sent to a room with giant displays. The picture being displayed on the walls of the screens all around is calibrated with the position where the person is located. This makes the subject see the simulation as if he is watching it for real. The acoustics system is synced well with the environment as well.
- 2 The subject is given wearable gadgets which are synced with each other and allow him to watch an ongoing simulation (video and audio) as if he is watching reality. The wearables also include gloves fitted with sensors to detect movements. Neck and body movements are also detected using other wired or wireless methods. These sensors send signals to the controller which then calculates the scene to be shown. The wearable devices also send feedback to the subject to make his experience more



Figure 3: The two ways of doing VR

real. For instance vibration could be induced on the subjects seat if the scene being viewed is that of a jeep going through a Safari.

Virtual reality is used in a lot of applications such as preliminary training exercises (e.g. for pilots and military) and entertainment. One of the lesser known usage of VR is for therapeutic purposes on psychological levels.

Virtual Reality and Augmented Reality - similarities

It might just seem that virtual reality is very different from augmented reality. After all, they look so different. Virtual reality is all about making you believe that you are in a place where you actually aren't, experiencing sensations that aren't there.